



PICTURE THIS: The year, 1980. The place, India. Television broadcasts are in black & white. Telephones occupy pride of place in many homes. Bollywood blockbuster *Qurbani* has introduced disco music to the masses with its hit song “Aap Jaisa Koi”. And during office hours, roads in most cities see a steady rush of Bajaj scooters; and Ambassador and Fiat cars that are manufactured by Kolkata-based Hindustan Motors and Mumbai-based Premier Automobiles, respectively.

While Maruti Udyog had been set up in the early 1970s with an aim to build a passenger car company that caters to the country’s growing middle class, it is far from taking off.

Let us fast forward a few years. Executives from Suzuki Motor

Corporation fly down from Japan with their technical know-how and investments—leading to the formation of Maruti Suzuki. The rest is history.

The Maruti Suzuki story has inspired a generation of entrepreneurs, including Sajjan Jindal, Chairman of diversified conglomerate JSW Group, who was beginning his journey then. “Making cars has been my childhood passion,” Jindal, 64, shared at an event more than 40 years later, adding that he built his first car in his garage when he was around 12. “And the passion of making cars has stayed with me.” Today, he is a happy man. After waiting for nearly four decades, he has achieved his dream of manufacturing passenger cars. In 2024, JSW Group picked up a 35% stake in MG Motor India. And like the Maruti story, with JSW MG Motor India—a joint venture with China’s leading carmaker, the state-owned SAIC Motor—Jindal plans to script history by transforming the local passenger car landscape, which is at the cusp of a green revolution, he revealed at the event to

announce the JV.

While he had harboured his dream for years, Jindal started things in earnest in 2015-16 when new energy vehicles (NEV) began gaining traction in India. In 2017 he started assembling a team to build EVs, but the Covid-19 pandemic brought his plans to a standstill. However, his dream was meant to be. As he put it (quoting a famous dialogue in Hindi from Shah Rukh Khan’s hit Bollywood movie *Om Shanti Om*), “When you wish for something with all your heart, the entire universe comes together to fulfil your wish.” With the pandemic completing its cycle and business activity back to normal, Jindal finally has his venture rolling. “We will create a Maruti moment like it happened in the early 1980s, when it entered the India market,” he said at the event in March.

THE HISTORY

The plan is simple. The management aims to rapidly grow the entity into an NEV company by adopting the latest technologies and

MONEY GAME

- MG’s sales have grown rapidly between FY20 and FY23
- But with ₹4,000 crore+ of capex and market development expenses, it remains in the red

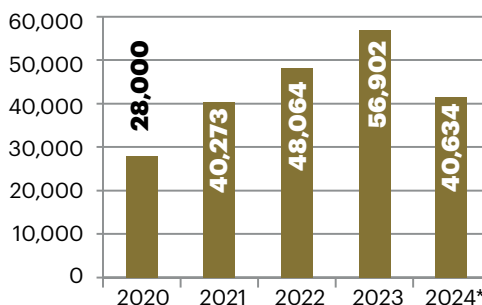
Segment	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23
Sales	2,569	4,595	5,329	7,636
EBITDA	-533.8	-513	-482.6	-114.6
Net profit/loss	-665	-716.8	-766.2	-826.8
Total assets	3,296	4,255	5,210	6,618

NOTE FIGURES IN NEGATIVE REPRESENT LOSS; EBITDA IS EARNINGS BEFORE INTEREST, TAX, DEPRECIATION, AND AMORTISATION; FIGURES IN ₹ CRORE

SOURCE CMIE PROWESS/ REGISTRAR OF COMPANIES, MCA

SALES BAROMETER

- MG’s PV sales surpassed 50,000 units in 2023
- It expects to touch the 70,000-mark in 2024



NOTE FIGURES REPRESENT PASSENGER VEHICLE (PV) SALES IN UNITS; *DATA FOR JAN-SEPTEMBER

SOURCE SIAM, COMPANY